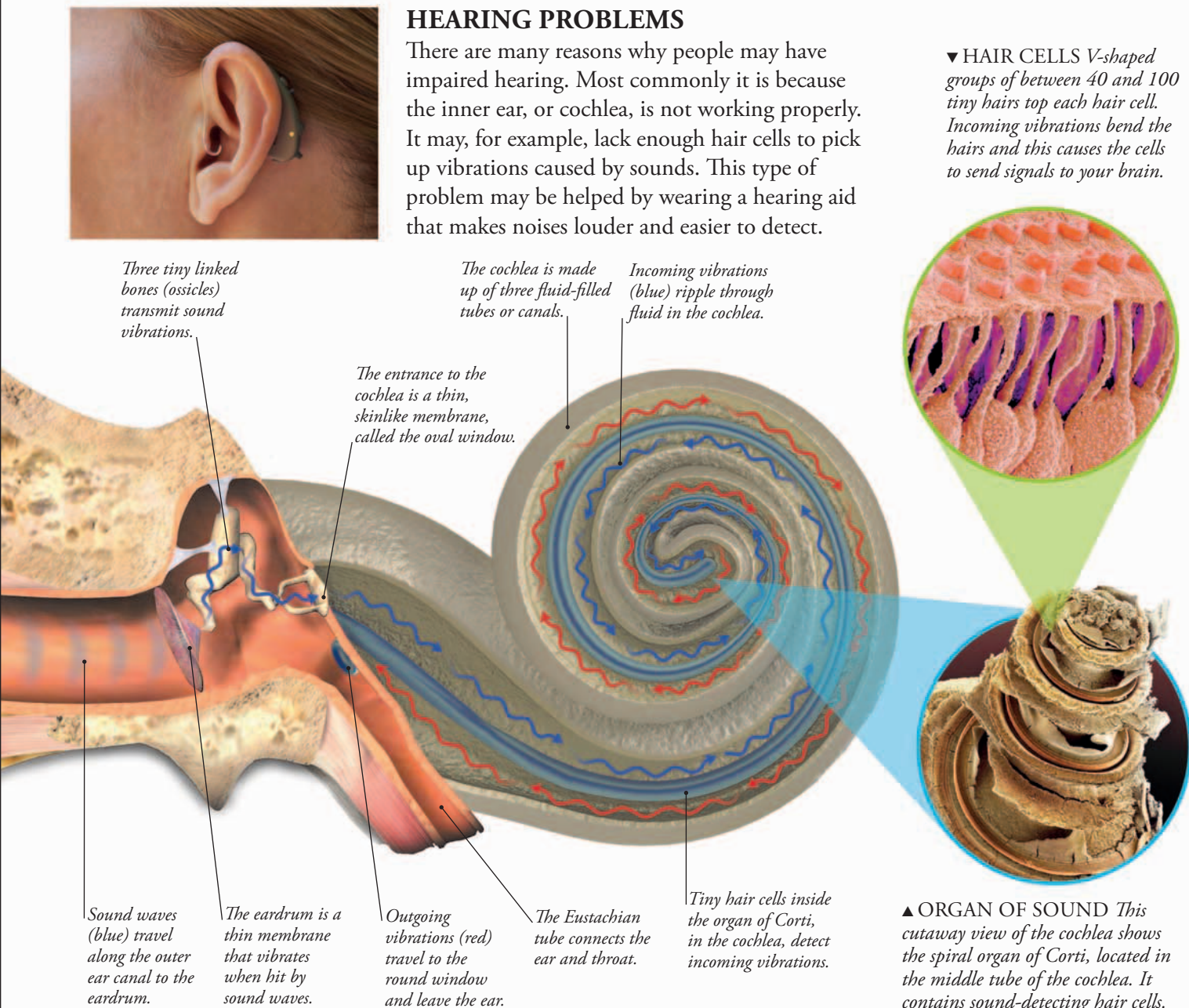


HEARING PROBLEMS

There are many reasons why people may have impaired hearing. Most commonly it is because the inner ear, or cochlea, is not working properly. It may, for example, lack enough hair cells to pick up vibrations caused by sounds. This type of problem may be helped by wearing a hearing aid that makes noises louder and easier to detect.

▼ **HAIR CELLS** V-shaped groups of between 40 and 100 tiny hairs top each hair cell. Incoming vibrations bend the hairs and this causes the cells to send signals to your brain.



HOW LOUD?

Our amazingly sensitive ears can hear everything from the rustling of leaves to the roar of a jet plane taking off. Sound intensity, which determines loudness, is measured in decibels. A really loud sound, such as a jackhammer, can damage the ears and lead to deafness.



Leaves rustling
10 decibels



Normal conversation
60 decibels



Jackhammer
100 decibels



Jet taking off
140 decibels